

# OVERVIEW OF OUR 1.5 DAYS TOGETHER

## DAY 1

**9:00 – 10:00** Session 1: Classroom Management for SLA

**10:30 – 12:00** Session 2: Combining SLA Theory with Practice

**12:00 – 13:30** lunch

**13:30 – 14:50** Session 3: How to Teach Vocabulary Effectively

**15:10 – 16:30** Session 4: Grammar Teaching

## DAY 2

**9:00 – 10:00** Session 5: Language Assessment

**10:30 – 12:00** Session 6: AI Role-Play Activities in SLA

**12:00 – 12:30** Feedback and Evaluation

## 2. Combining SLA Theory with Practice

Margreet Vogelzang



# OBJECTIVES



By the end of the session, you will be able to:

- **Describe** typical stages of L1 language development
- **Identify** key differences between L1 and L2 acquisition
- **Understand** important frameworks for second-language learning
- **Understand** differences between learner styles

# OVERVIEW

- (Typical) L1 development
- How is L2 acquisition different?
  - Comprehensible input
  - Learning from mistakes
- Frameworks for second-language teaching and learning
  - Present-Practice-Produce (PPP)
  - Engage-Study-Activate (ESA)
- Ice-breaking activities and understanding the different styles of second-language learners

# (TYPICAL) L1 DEVELOPMENT



What is to be acquired  
and what are the important milestones?

# WHAT NEEDS TO BE ACQUIRED BY ANY LEARNER

- A **vocabulary** of some 50,000 words
- The different **forms** of words (morphology) and structures of sentences (word order)
- The **meaning** associated with words, forms and structures
- The **organisation of information** within and across sentences
- **Using language appropriately** with different people and in different situations

# DEVELOPMENTAL MILESTONES

- *Babbling (6-7 months)*
- *Recognition and categorisation of sounds (10 months)*
- *Prelinguistic communication (1 year)*
- *First words (1;0-1;3 years); 100-600 words at 2;0 years;  
14,000 at age 6*

# DEVELOPMENTAL MILESTONES

- *Babbling* (6-7 months)
- *Recognition and categorisation of sounds* (10 months)
- *Prelinguistic communication* (1 year)
- *First words* (1;0-1;3 years); 100-600 words at 2;0 years; 14,000 at age 6
- *Two-word stage* (from 2;0 years onwards)
- *Understanding the structure of language* (2;6-3;0)
  - Word order and morphology
- *Complex sentences* (4 years – 7 years)
- *Discourse* (7-10 years only)

(Clark, 2003)



# LEXICAL DEVELOPMENT

- First words (12 months). Rate of development gradually increases from 12 months to sometime after the age of 10 years
- Rate of development slows down sometime before the age of 17 years. (Vocabulary size of a 10-year-old is around 40.000 words going up to 60.000 when leaving secondary school)
- Individual variation: e.g., 16 months: 0-8 words (for the bottom 10% group of children), 40 (for the middle group) and 179-347 (for the top 10%) (Fenson et al, 1994)

# WHAT IS A WORD?

Words involve **mappings** between form and meanings/concepts

Two-step model of lexical acquisition:

1. *Identification and storage of word forms;*
2. *Stored forms are linked to meaning.*



# HOW DO CHILDREN LEARN NEW WORDS?

Necessary or sufficient prerequisites:

- Communication (including joint attention)
- Cognition
- Language

# MORPHOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT

Structure of words, including how they are formed, their roots, prefixes, suffixes, and relationships to other words (e.g. walk/walked, cat/cats, happy/happiness)

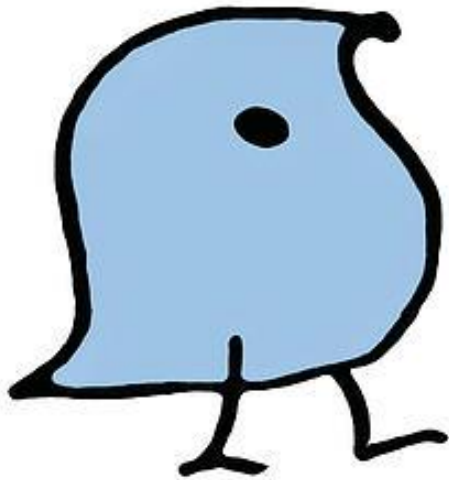
# MORPHOLOGICAL DEVELOPMENT

More salient morphemes productively combined earlier

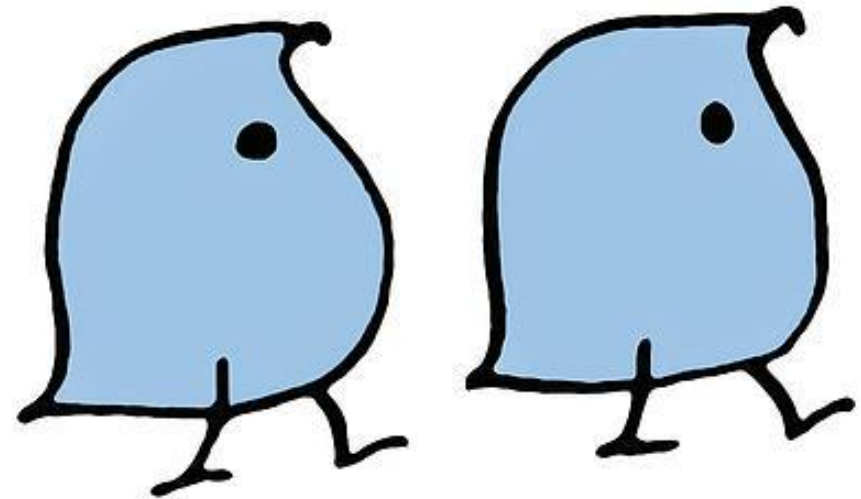
Saliency =

- Morphemes located in prominent place, i.e., beginning or end of word or in very predictable place with regards to other words or within words
- Morphemes that can carry stress
- Morphemes that have more easily identifiable semantic content

# WUG TEST



THIS IS A WUG®



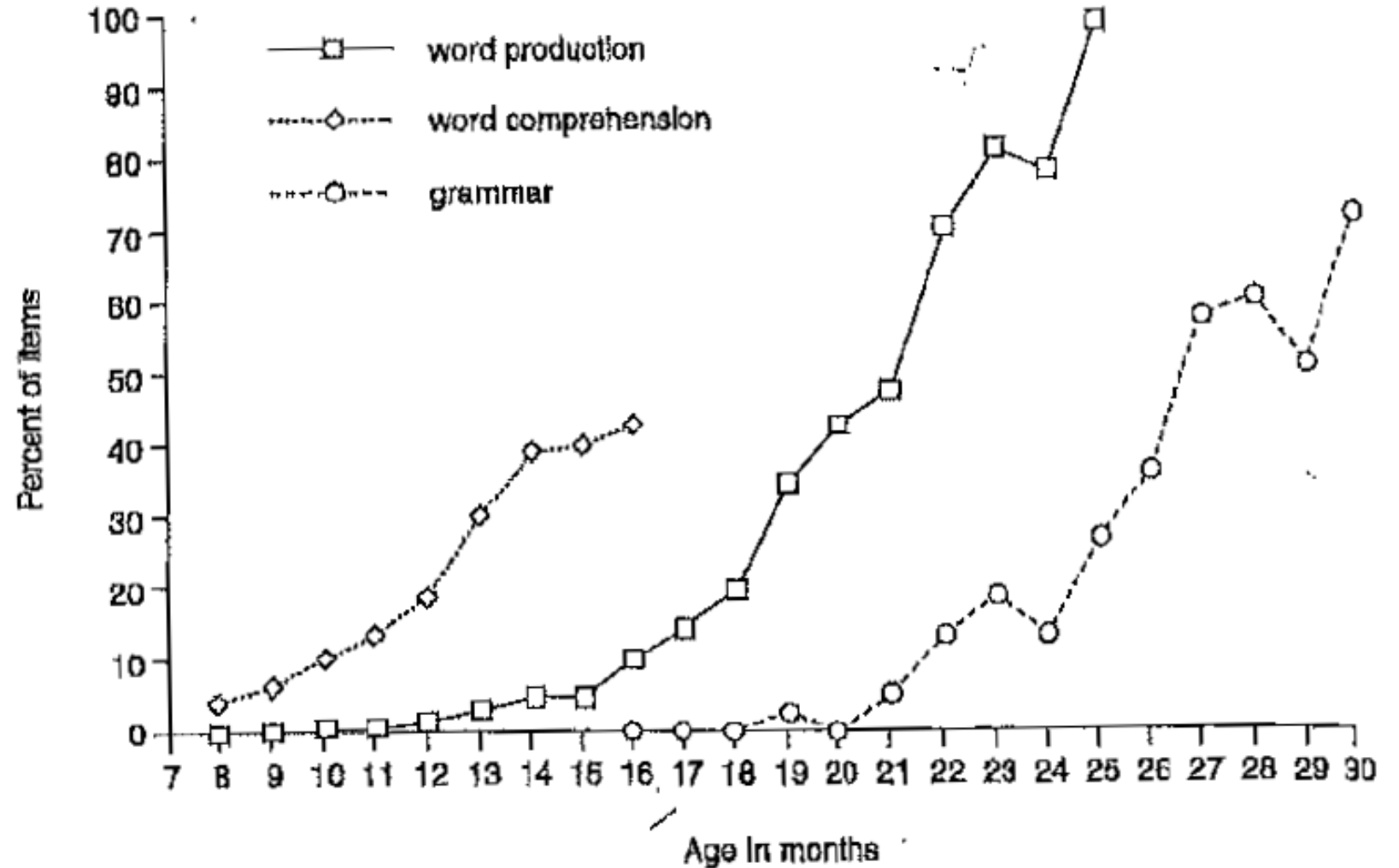
NOW THERE IS ANOTHER ONE  
THERE ARE TWO OF THEM  
THERE ARE TWO \_\_\_\_\_

Source: <https://fineartamerica.com/featured/wug-test-jean-berko-gleason.html>

# GRAMMAR

24-30 months: first  
morphosyntax

36-42 months: basic  
morphosyntax  
mastered



**Figure 10.1** Median growth scores for word comprehension, production and grammar expressed as a percent of available items.

From Bates and Goodman 2001, pg. 136

# MORPHOSYNTAX DEVELOPMENT

Kitty sleeping

Kitty is sleeping

“Which sentence in the pair sounds more like the way that your child is talking right now?”

Teeth, made

Tooths, maked

“Have you heard your child produce any of these forms?”



# MORPHOSYNTAX LATER IN DEVELOPMENT

## Syntactic movement:

In simple sentences we identify canonical positions of categories like subject and object

*You discuss the report in that room*

A category can move from canonical position (**e** or gap position) to the surface position (**filler**)

*Which report* did you discuss **e** in that room?



# MORPHOSYNTAX LATER IN DEVELOPMENT

*Which report* did you discuss *e* in that room?



*The report* that you discussed *e* is in that room



*The report* was discussed *e* in that room



*The report* seems to be *e* in that room



# MORPHOSYNTAX LATER IN DEVELOPMENT



Negation:

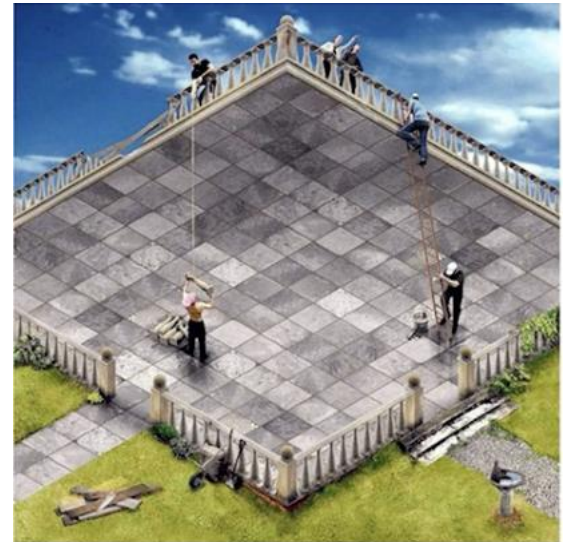
*They had only just moved in; their boxes lay on the kitchen floor, still unpacked.*

Anything weird about this sentence?

# MORPHOSYNTAX LATER IN DEVELOPMENT

*I can't recommend this person highly enough*

What does this sentence mean? Is it good or not?



# A COMPLEX TASK

- Language acquisition is a complex task and many facets need to be acquired
- Even though we have not yet fully analysed all languages in the world, children can learn any of them in a relatively short period of time
- Acquisition takes place in stages
- Language is distinctly human

# ROLE OF THE ENVIRONMENT

How does what children hear and how they hear it affect their language development?

- Role of social interaction
- Role of input (quantity and quality of speech)



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**BREAK? — 10 MIN**



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# L2 ACQUISITION

Differences between child L2 acquisition and child/adult L2 learning. We'll focus mainly on L2 learning



# DIFFERENCES BETWEEN CHILD L1 AND ADULT L2

|                                                                       | Child L1<br>Monolingual<br>& bilingual | Adult L2          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Learning just<br>through exposure<br>to data, no explicit<br>teaching | ✓                                      | ?                 |
| Achievement                                                           | ✓                                      | Not by<br>default |
| Age                                                                   | 0 - ca. 3 years                        | After<br>puberty  |

# POSSIBLE EXPLANATIONS FOR DIFFICULTIES

- Adult learner is older and therefore less efficient learner (age only)
- Adult learner tackles language acquisition in different way from children (strategy)
- Adult learner may have problems with interference from L1 (transfer)
- Adult learner may not have access to language acquisition device (or UG)

But there is often success!

# L2 LEARNER ADVANTAGES

- They don't start from scratch – they already have knowledge of a language
- Existing vocabulary and grammar can be built upon
- They can use their L1 (first language) knowledge to make connections with the L2
- They may already have learning strategies/skills
- Prior experience can make it easier to understand new concepts and communicate
- They can focus on developing and refining their language rather than learning everything for the first time

# WHAT IS REQUIRED TO LEARN/IMPROVE?

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Important factors in  
second-language learning  
(and teaching)



# 1. COMPREHENSIBLE INPUT

**Comprehensible input** is language that learners can understand, even if they do not understand every word

Learners need exposure to meaningful and understandable language

Input should be slightly above the learner's current level.

Teachers can make input easier to understand through:

- Context
- Visuals and gestures
- Examples
- Repetition and clarification

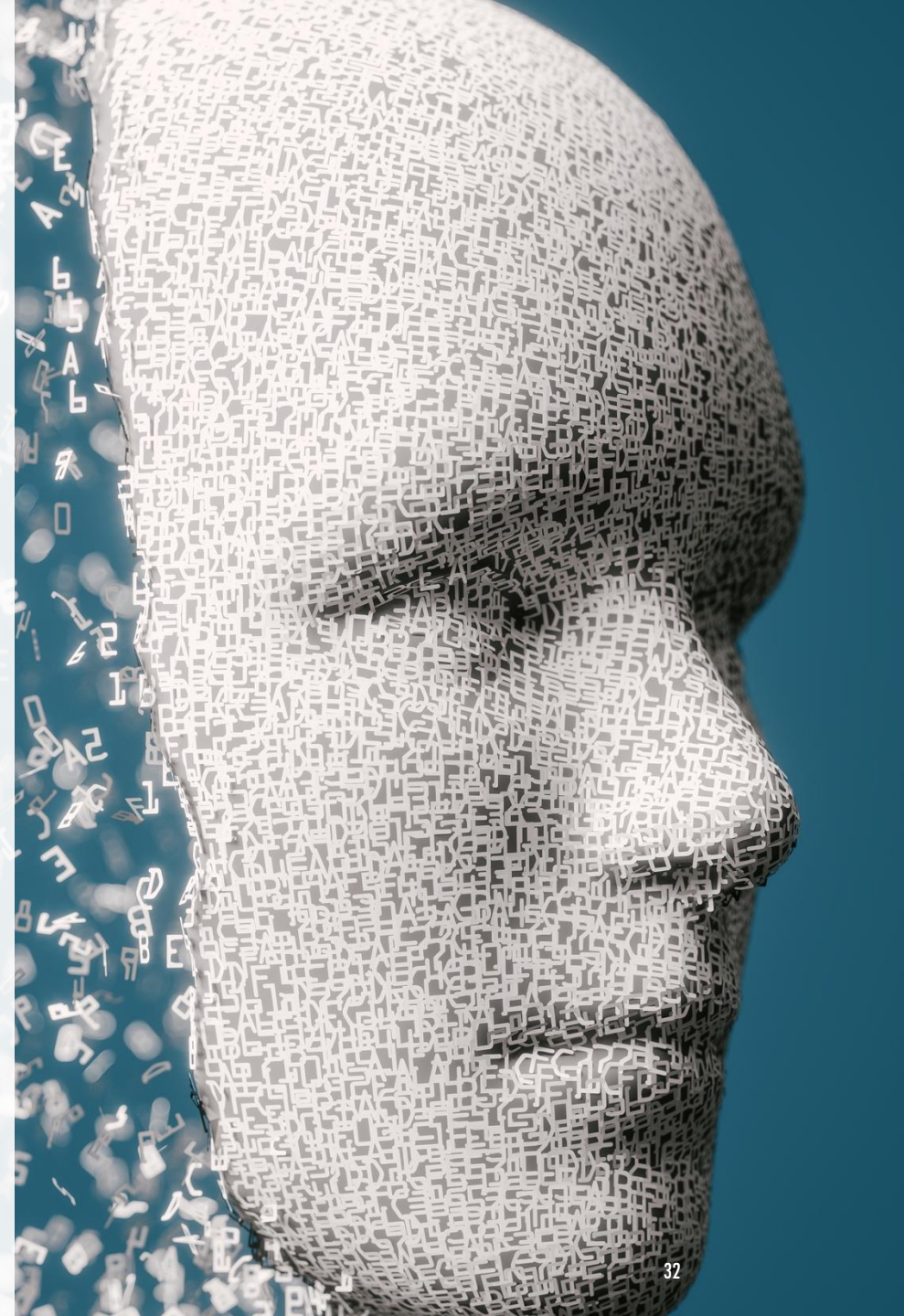
Input helps learners develop vocabulary, grammar, listening, and overall language ability



# THE ROLE OF AI

AI can increase the (amount of) L2 input learners receive by providing:

- Level-appropriate texts for reading
- Conversations at the learner's level
- Different topics and situations based on learners' interests
- Simplified or expanded versions of the same text
- Explanations of unfamiliar vocabulary and expressions
- Opportunities to interact with L2 language anytime and anywhere





## 2. LEARNING FROM MISTAKES

Mistakes are a natural and important part of second-language learning

Errors show what learners understand and what they are still developing

Learners can improve by noticing and correcting their mistakes

Feedback helps learners understand:

- What was incorrect
- Why it was incorrect
- How to improve

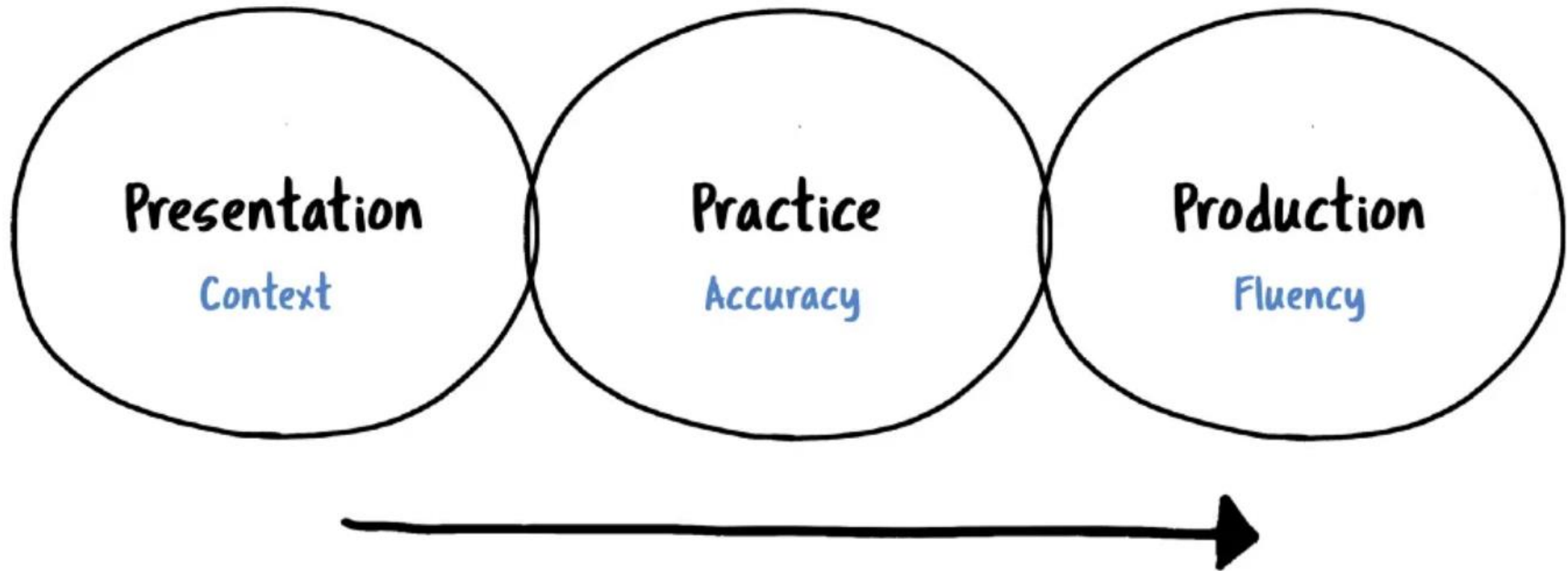
Teachers should create a supportive environment where learners are not afraid to make mistakes

Not every mistake needs to be corrected immediately

# FRAMEWORKS FOR SECOND-LANGUAGE TEACHING AND LEARNING



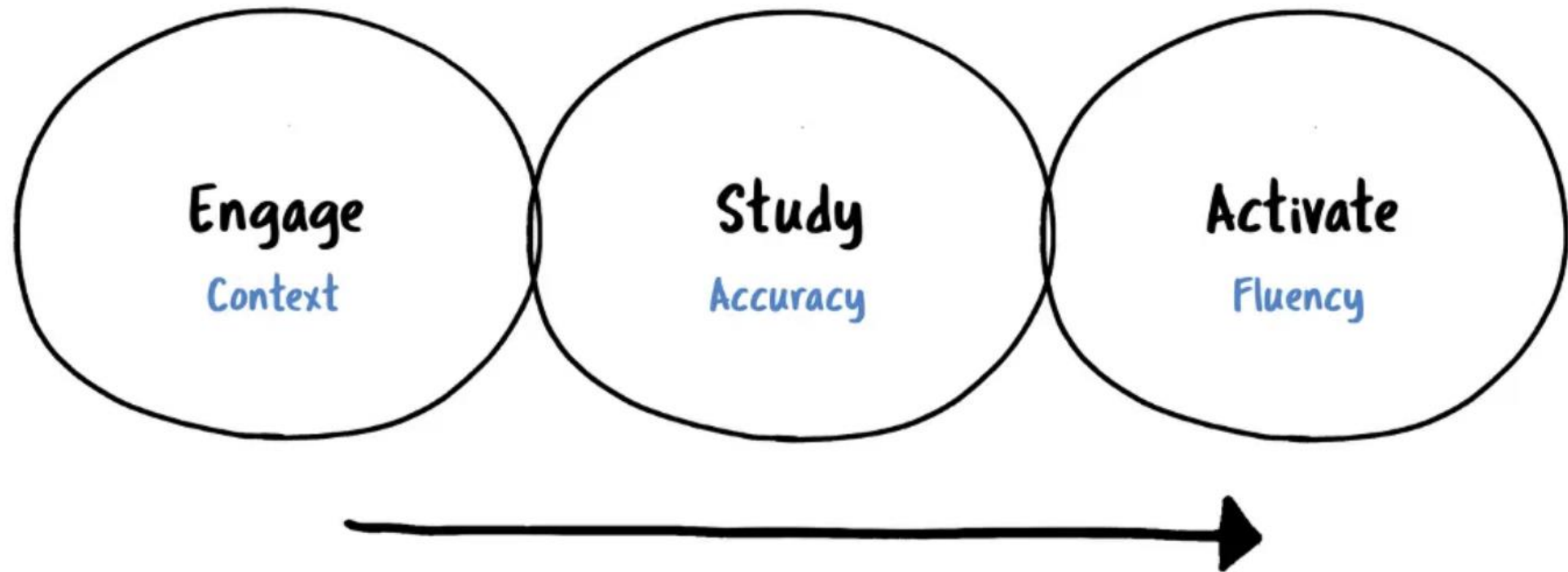
Present, Practice,  
Produce (PPP)



- **Present:** Teacher introduces new language and explains its meaning and form
- **Practice:** Learners practise the language through controlled activities
- **Produce:** Learners use the language more freely in communication



# Engage-Study- Activate (ESA)



- Each stage of ESA roughly corresponds to PPP
- But with ESA the stages can be moved around or used more than once

# ENGAGE-STUDY-ACTIVATE (ESA)

## Straight Arrows

E S A

## Boomerang

e.g. E A S A

## Patchwork

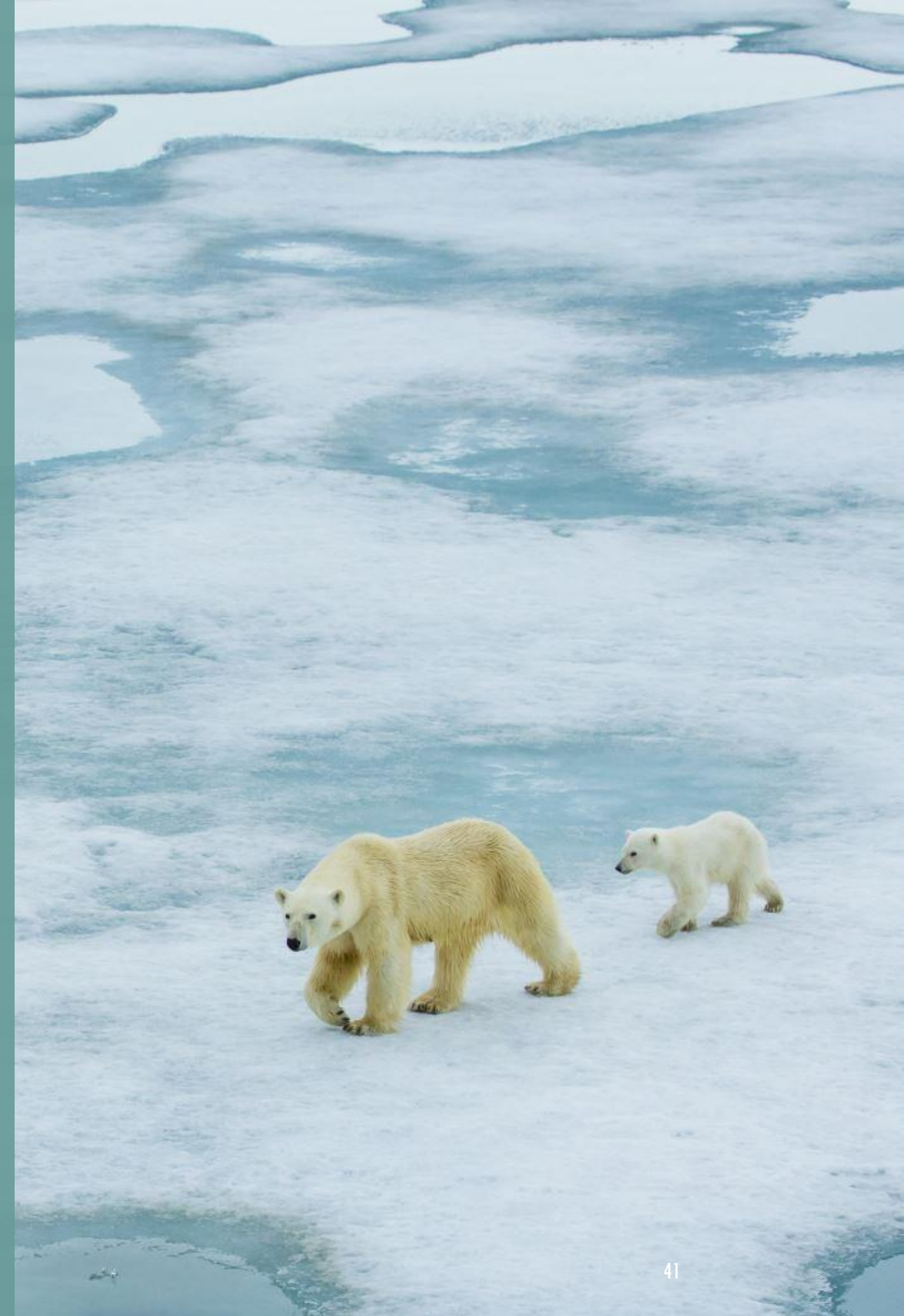
e.g. E A S A S E

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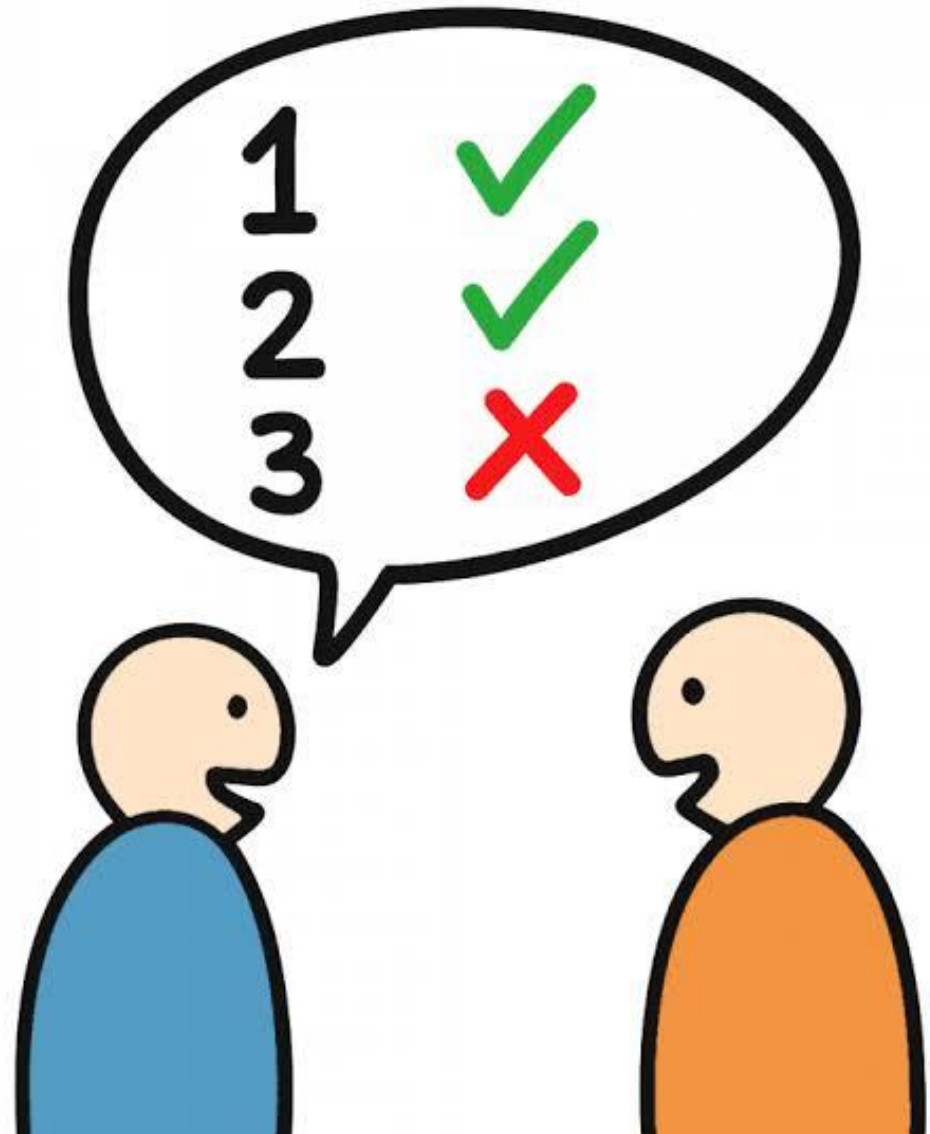
# SOME ICEBREAKERS



# TWO TRUTHS AND A LIE

Each person says 3  
things about themselves:  
2 true and 1 false

The others guess the lie



# BALL TOSS

Stand/sit in a circle and throw a ball to someone

When you catch it, say your name + one interesting fact about yourself

Throw the ball to someone else

Continue until everyone has had at least 3 turns



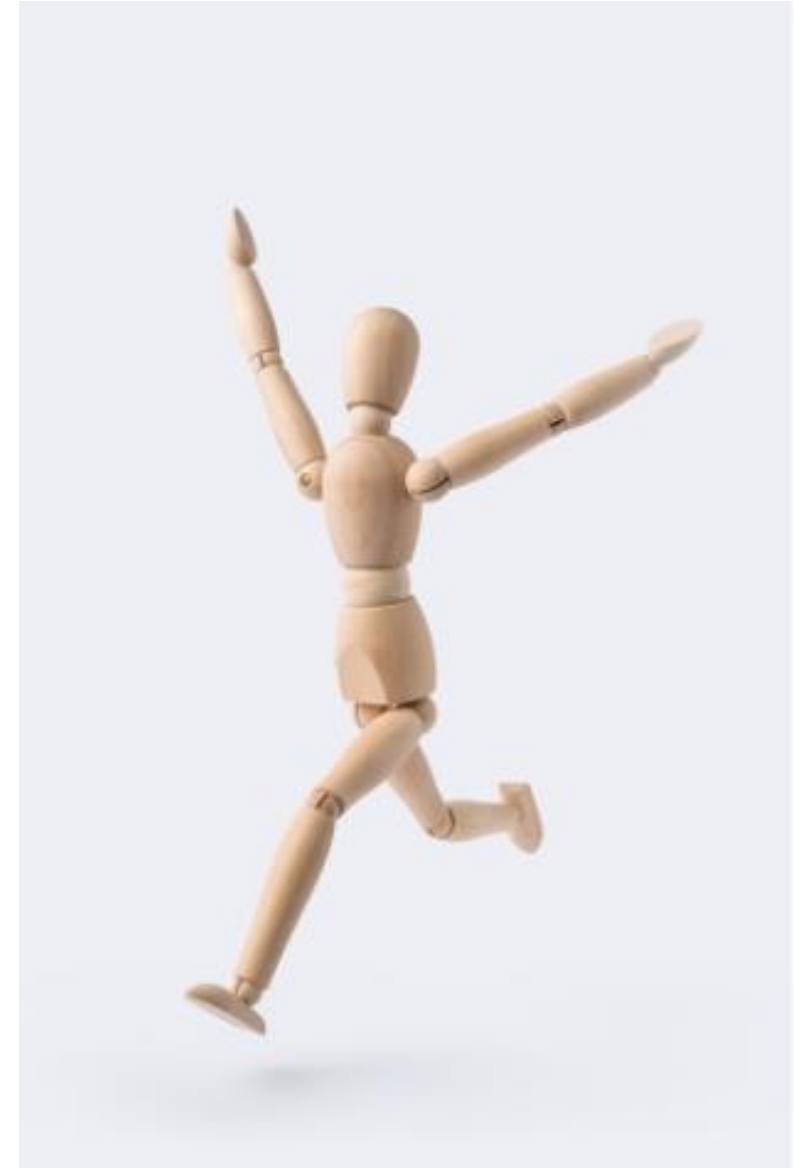
# “MOVE IF...”

“Move to the left if you enjoy speaking activities.”

“Move to the right if you prefer working alone.”

“Move forward if you learn best by doing.”

“Stay where you are if you prefer reading/writing.”



# IN PAIRS, DISCUSS

One learner is shy, one loves speaking, and one prefers working alone. How would you teach them?



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